01 / 05

YOUR CODING AGENT SAYS

"The prompt is broken."

Maybe. A failure can start in **nine** places.
Editing the prompt fixes **one**.

EVAL HARNESS · IMPROVEMENT LOOP · CROSS-VENDOR JUDGES · MEMORY

ENDPOINT

01	02	03
Su	Cg	Ra
04	05	06
Jv	Fm	If
07	08	09
Pp	Sa	Ce

Titration finds which one, with judges from **other vendors**.

9	18	66	≥2
FAILURE ORIGINS	MCP TOOLS	STARTER CARDS	VENDORS PER SCORE

mL

open source · Apache-2.0
self-hosted · any MCP client

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THE NINE FAILURE ORIGINS

The periodic table of *agent failure.*

One failure, one origin, **one place to fix it.**

01 MODEL

Su

system-under-test

the model really got it wrong

fix → the prompt

The only one that means "edit the prompt."

Misread another as **01** and you fix the wrong thing.

02 TEST SET

Cg

corpus-gap

the tests never exercise the case

fix → the corpus

03 GRADING

Ra

rubric-ambiguity

too vague to judge consistently

fix → the rubric

04 GRADING

Jv

judge-variance

judges disagree below the noise floor

fix → the judges

05 PIPELINE

Fm

formatter

code after the model broke good output

fix → the formatter

07 TEST SET

Pp

pre-existing-pattern

already failing in the baseline

fix → not this change

06 GRADING

If

instrument-failure

the measurement itself is wrong

fix → the harness

FAMILIES

- model
- test set
- grading
- pipeline
- runtime

08 PIPELINE

Sa

state-artifact

an earlier turn corrupted this one

fix → upstream

09 RUNTIME

Ce

cost-exhausted

the loop ran out of budget

fix → the budget

Eight of nine are not a prompt problem.

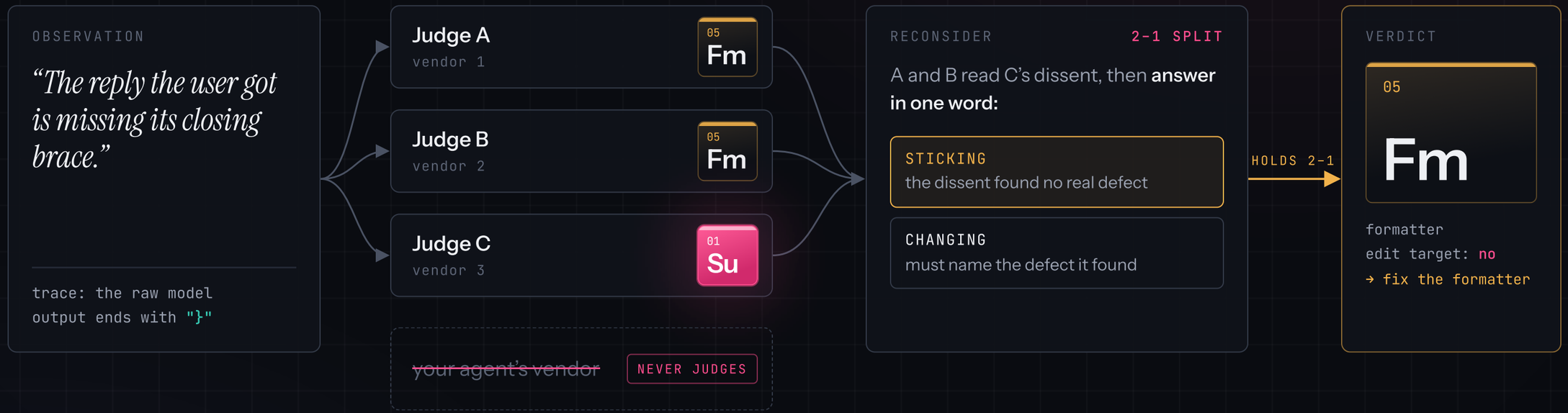
Split evidence **never defaults to 01.**

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HOW IT DECIDES

Three judges, three vendors. A split gets *argued*, not averaged.



Judges diagnose, never prescribe.
The fix is yours to choose.

Confidence is not evidence.
Changing an answer means naming the defect.

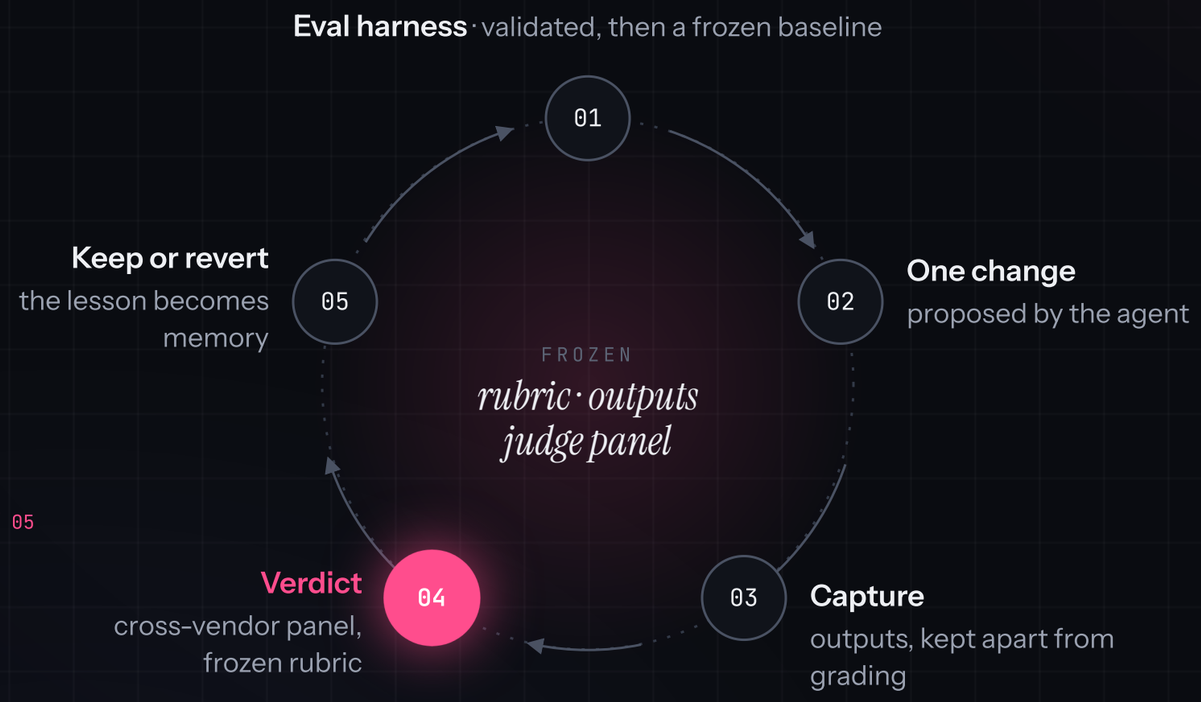
Nothing is thrown away.
Both rounds stay in the audit trail.

mL

THE IMPROVEMENT LOOP

One change at a time, against a baseline that *doesn't move.*

"When a measure becomes a target, it ceases to be a good measure." GOODHART'S LAW · MARILYN STRATHERN



RULES OF EVIDENCE

i. **The model never grades its own work.**
Your agent's vendor never sits on the panel.

ii. **Agreement, or no score.**
At least two vendor families must answer, or there is no score.

iii. **Memory that compounds.**
Findings become cards, searched with 66 starter methods.

90% → 0%

REAL RUN · EXAMPLES/TICKET-TRIAGE
Billing tickets wrongly marked urgent, fixed in one measured change. Noise floor ±1.1 pts, 90 of 90 votes.

GET STARTED

On your machine in *about five minutes.*

~/titration

```
$ git clone https://github.com/kaithoughtarchitect/titration.git
$ cd titration
$ docker compose up -d        # Postgres + pgvector
$ npm install
$ cp .env.example .env        # add OPENROUTER_API_KEY
$ npm run setup

# connect your agent, e.g. Claude Code
$ claude mcp add -s user titration -- npx tsx "$PWD/server/server.ts"
```

- New here? Start with **examples/ticket-triage**: two planted bugs, one measured fix.

YOU NEED

- **Node.js 22.11+** and **Docker**
- An **OpenRouter** key. The **claude · codex · grok** CLIs can fill up to two judge seats.

HELP BUILD IT

- Add a learning to the starter pack
- Verify the **grok** judge door
- Run it on a real agent change, open an issue

"The first principle is that you must not fool yourself and you are the easiest person to fool."

RICHARD FEYNMAN

STAR · FORK · CONTRIBUTE

github.com/kaithoughtarchitect/titration